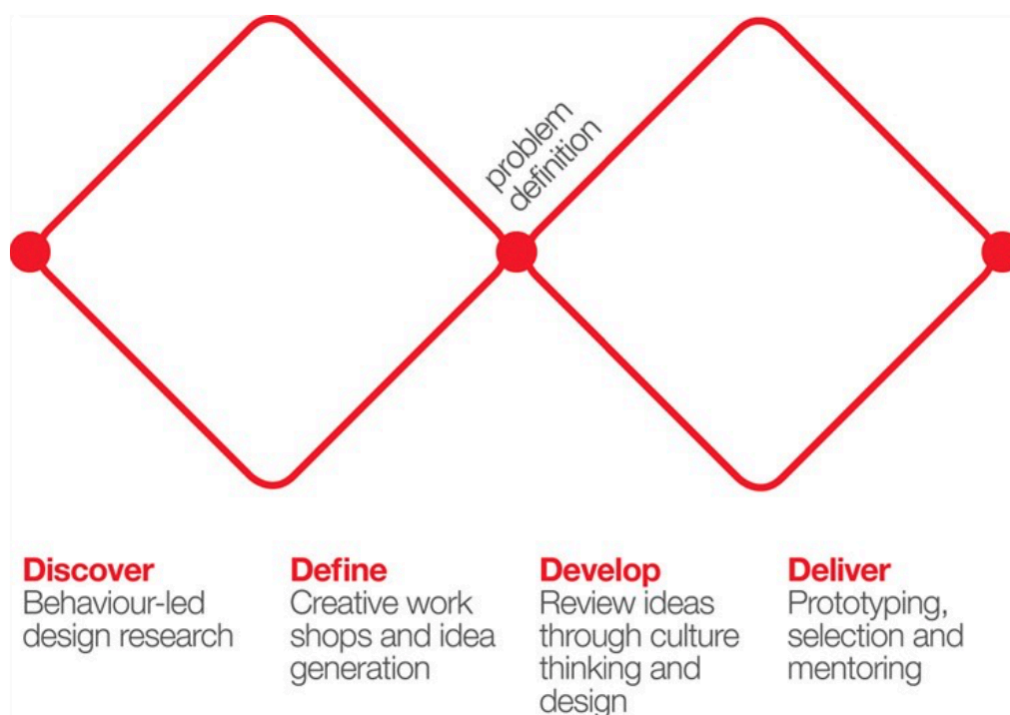


Designing for Real People Project 2026

The application of methods and tools in design and technology to
create better experiences in people's everyday lives

March – June 2026



Introduction

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[RCA Module Leads:](#)

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[RCA Tutor Team:](#)

[Andrea Edmunds, Visiting Tutor,](#)

[Service Design - Royal College of Art](#)

[Carolyn Runcie, Programme Manager and Tutor](#)

[Service Design - Royal College of Art](#)

[Dr Nick de Leon](#)

[Service Design - Royal College of Art](#)

[Nicolas Rebolledo, Tutor](#)

[Service Design - Royal College of Art](#)

Human Centred Design References

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Introduction

The Designing for Real People Project is run by the Imperial College London Department of Computing and Royal College of Art Masters in Service Design Programme.

The module introduces students to design and technical tools, skills and approaches that will help teams to develop innovative experiences for people in their everyday lives, part of which will involve building meaningful digital interactions within that context, the focus being on a digital touchpoint.

Student teams will work on a project chosen either from an industry project or their own project that's based on an area of interest to them (e.g. food waste) which will enable them to focus on challenges and opportunities faced by people in relevant scenarios (e.g. food bank charities where those involved may be frontline staff delivering food to those in need).

This chosen project will require teams to understand the people involved in that context, what they do and some of the challenges they may face in everyday life. Understanding this will inevitably reveal a variety of interactions, both physical (e.g. face-to-face in a range of physical environments) and digital (websites, apps, texts, phone calls and using different digital devices, dynamic signage, kiosks etc.). These interactions, or touchpoints, happening over time form part of the overall experience for the people involved, each one needing to be developed with the socio-cultural context in mind.

Consequently, students will be expected to build a digital touchpoint within their chosen context (an innovative multi-user web or mobile application), that will cater for the needs of a specific target audience rather than purely focusing on the technical aspects in isolation. This digital touchpoint should support and involve real-time user interactions and must maintain a consistent internal state via use of a server-side database.

However, this is not the starting point of the project, but rather just one key touchpoint in a person's overall experience. Examples of suitable digital touchpoints could include collaborative publishing tools, social-media services or even online-games, but must be justified by suitable background research and investigation into your chosen problem through the use of Human Centred Design techniques.

What will students learn about in this module?

Design Knowledge and Understanding:

- Apply human-centred research methods to analyse a complex socio-cultural and technical systems environment to determine HCD requirements for a digital touchpoint
- Exploit methods and practices in HCD to develop the design of a digital touchpoint that engages and meets the needs of relevant stakeholders within a specific context
- Prototype or simulate a design concept, and evaluate the effectiveness and desirability for the target audience and user community as well as its technical feasibility.

Skills and other attributes:

- Evaluate complex systems environments in terms of key stakeholders involved and apply a human centred approach to the determination of system requirements to achieve overall system and design objectives.
- Understand different user types and capabilities/limitations and reflect these in the design of an integrated multimodal solution (Web, Mobile as well as Embedded Physical/Analogue etc)
- Understand how to design a multimodal solution that combines technological, organisational and human interactions to fulfil the system and design objectives
- Select the most appropriate HCD research methods to identify requirements and create new insights to stimulate innovation in a systems environment.
- Present a solution proposal describing the rationale for the technological and HCD decisions, including the HCI attributes, and articulate a compelling value proposition for each of the key stakeholders – end-user, solution provider, intermediaries.

Transferable skills:

- Design Research Methodologies and application of creative problem framing / problem solving
- Accomplish a design task, working within a team under time pressure
- Report, present and demonstrate a solution and value proposition to an inter-disciplinary panel

Teaching and Project Activities

The module is made up of a short taught course and has been structured to take you on a journey that seeks to mirror a design process and offers a unique opportunity to build your knowledge, skills and expertise in design-led innovation. The tools and techniques introduced in this module are as relevant to those working in a start-up businesses as those in large organisations.

Four weekly milestone reviews, attended by an Imperial and a RCA Tutor, will guide teams through the project, from identifying and solving a problem within their chosen context, to developing and testing a digital interface with the target audience. Students experience first-hand the challenges when applying HCD methods and balancing these with the development of an associated digital touchpoint. There will also be regular live lab clinic hours throughout the four weeks of the project to check in with both Imperial and RCA Tutors, as well as a team of MA Service Design students, on how you're progressing and what challenges you may need help with.

Human Centred Design Course Structure

Wednesday 18th March 2026	
Module 1 (11:00 - 13:00) Introduction to Human-Centred Design (HCD) Dr. Nick de Leon Executive Education and Knowledge Exchange Lead, Royal College of Art	- Introduces students to design and creative methods - Explores the importance of the HCD approach, especially in the ICT sector and the role of HCI within HCD. - Informs students of key principles of HCD and demonstrates the application of these principles through case studies of successful and unsuccessful designs.
Thursday 29th March 2026	
Module 2 (11:00 - 13:00) Human Centred Design Principles and Practice (Discover and Define) Dr. Nick de Leon Executive Education and Knowledge Exchange Lead, Royal College of Art	- Reviews in more detail specific design methodologies and gives students a deeper understanding of the design process and HCD research methods to apply to their project in order to explore their chosen area of interest, identify problems, come up with ideas, then test and develop those ideas - Examines techniques for HCD Research including, rapid ethnography, use of personas, design interventions and their applicability to different environments and users/stakeholders - Explores how to develop HCD insights, and frame problems so as to create a compelling opportunity statement and design brief for a digital touchpoint - Demonstrates this approach through case studies - Briefing for Workshop
Friday 20th March 2026	
Module 3 (10:00 - 13:00 and 14:00 - 16:00) Design Workshop (Discover and Define) Carolyn Runcie and Clare Brass, Tutors, Masters in Service Design Programme - Royal College of Art A team of Masters in Service Design students will also be on hand for guiding workshop activities	- In your teams, review a range of design methods then choose a scenario to apply them to. - Work through provided exercises in your teams under the guidance of design tutors and service design students.. You will learn to apply design methods that will enable you to: - Explore the people who are part of the context within a challenge area - Create a persona who will inspire ideas for - Create a user journey map to understand problems and opportunities in a chosen scenario - Create an opportunity statement in relation to a specific context - Come up with ideas to solve problems - Create a vision for a newly imagined experience

Monday 18th May 2026	
Module 4 (12.00 - 13.00) Storytelling David Eveleigh-Evans, Visiting Tutor, Service Design - Royal College of Art	- Examines narratives and storytelling to successfully communicate innovative ideas. - Conveys the importance of getting the balance right between digital interactions and how they fit into people's lives and motivations
Tuesday 19th May 2026	
Module 5 (11:00-13:00) Testing Ideas and Digital Prototyping (Design and Develop) Andrea Edmunds, Visiting Tutor, Service Design - Royal College of Art	- Provides an overview of different kinds of prototypes for different design stages of a project - Explores how students can test ideas and to create successful digital prototypes - Underlines the role and importance of involving people when introducing the logic behind prototyping digital services - Demonstrates how to prototype a concept through using user journeys, storyboards and design mock-ups - Reviews different techniques of designing interactions, and related prototyping
Wednesday 20th May 2026	
Module 6 (10:00 - 12:00) User Experience (Design and Develop) David Eveleigh-Evans, Visiting Tutor, Service Design - Royal College of Art	- Provides an overview of user experience and how a <i>user</i> interacts with, and <i>experiences</i>, a product. - Examines the importance of understanding a person's emotions and attitudes about using a particular product, system or service. - Reviews the practical, experiential, meaningful and valuable aspects of human-computer interaction - Examines a person's perceptions of system aspects such as utility, ease of use and efficiency.
Tuesday 26th May 2026	
Module 7 (12:00 - 13.00) Service Systems Dr. Nick de Leon Executive Education and Knowledge Exchange Lead, Royal College of Art	Concerns how design of products and services fit into much larger technological and social systems as well as discusses the role of design in services

Organise your Project Team:

Your first task is to set up a group of four people for the project. Note that you do not need to submit any files for this task, just make sure you set up and sign off on your group in the normal way via Scientia. The groups created on Scientia will be used to assign any shared group resources for the DRP project in the Summer term.

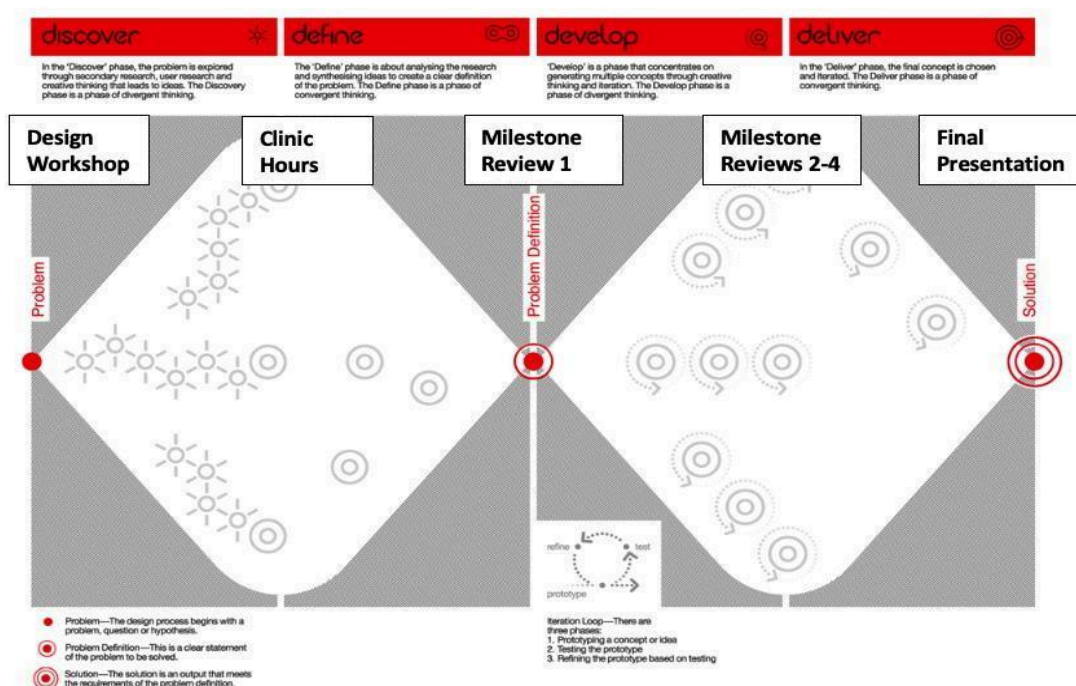
Once in teams, you are encouraged to agree on an area of interest or project idea that you are all passionate about. Try to think outside of the box and come up with something original.

The suggested design framework to help you manage the project is the 'Double Diamond' design process, published in 2005 by the UK Design Council (see below). This should help students balance the design-led approach with the technical skills needed when developing a digital touchpoint.

In order for student teams to apply this design process effectively, we've created a series of talks and a full-day workshop to help teams:

1. **Understand** how design methods can be applied to a chosen context;
2. **Define** the problems or opportunities within this context and create a brief to start working from;
3. **Develop** concepts that will involve a digital touchpoint as part of the new experience;
4. **Create Impact** through a final proposition within which the digital touchpoint plays an important role.

The design process requires a particular approach and mindset that, when used in combination with the design of technological systems, will create a compelling new experience for those involved.



Project Management:

You should carefully consider how your group is organised and what project management tools you want to use to coordinate your work. A well organised group will be able to make more efficient use of the relatively short project time and will produce a better final solution to their chosen problem.

You should also decide on a method that enables you to divide the work amongst your group members and ensures that you are able to demo your whole solution at the end of each project iteration. Additionally, you should make sure that you are tracking your core objectives, desired feature lists and what each group member is doing. You will find this useful when writing up your project documentation and preparing for your final presentation and demonstration.

Version Control:

It is vitally important that you backup and manage your work (code and design documentation) using a concurrent version control system, such as git. This will allow you to more efficiently work together as a team and also to maintain a working version of your supporting digital touchpoint at all times. We suggest that you [set up a GitLab group](#) or use a reliable external service (e.g [GitHub](#)). You can also find [CSG's version control guide](#) online.

Testing:

To ensure that your supporting digital touchpoint behaves correctly, you are expected to use continuous automated testing. In the 2nd Year Laboratory “DevOps and Continuous Delivery” exercise we discussed how to set up a pipeline to run all of your tests for every version of your code and deploy successful updates to a public server - you should do this for your DRP project.

Remember that any user acceptance testing should be carried out with *representative* users. You should ensure that you have access to suitable potential users as part of choosing the theme for your project. You should also make sure that your supporting digital touchpoint can tolerate unexpected or malicious input gracefully.

Working Away from the Department:

If you choose to work on your project remotely be sure to keep in mind the following:

- Do not spend too much time trying to install and debug software on your machine that is already available on the lab machines.
- Do not try to work on the Department's shell servers, as these (deliberately) do not have a full set of lab software installed on them. Instead, you are advised to connect to a lab machine from the shell servers.
- Keep in regular contact with your group so that you remain on task and avoid duplicating work.
- Make sure you back-up your work regularly. You should be using a version control system as mentioned above.
- Make sure that any software you want to use as part of your demonstrations is available within the Department before you start using it.
- Test your work on the Department's servers and allow time to find and fix bugs before your demonstrations.

Additional Resources:

Some introductory notes on architectural design patterns for web applications, taken from Robert Chatley's COMP50002 Software Engineering Design module, can be found on Scientia. CSG also provide [a guide on web hosting](#) and [a guide on database usage](#) which you may find helpful during the project.

Technical Requirements for your Digital Touchpoint:

You are free to structure your supporting digital touchpoint in any way you wish, using any choice of implementation language(s). However it must fulfil all of the following requirements:

- Your digital touchpoint must help to solve a **clearly identified real-world problem** and be designed with **representative users** (not yourself) in mind.
- Your digital touchpoint must be **multi-user** and should allow for **rich user interactions** (e.g. messaging, scoreboards, collaboration, etc...).
- Your digital touchpoint must support **real-time user interactions**, as should be expected of any modern web-based or mobile application.
- Your digital touchpoint must use a database to maintain some **persistent internal state** (e.g. user specific data, scores, event data, etc...).
- You must continuously integrate changes from all team members, and use a **continuous integration** (CI) and **continuous deployment** (CD) server to help you guarantee the quality of your code-base.
- Your digital touchpoint must run on at least one of the web browsers installed on the lab machines (e.g. Firefox, Google Chrome, Chromium, Internet Explorer). Alternatively, if you are designing a mobile application, it should run on one of the mobile devices available on loan from the lab. Ideally, any mobile application should also be accessible on at least one of the web browsers above.
- Any additional plug-ins required for your digital touchpoint must be freely available and you must provide users with clear instructions on how to install them.
- You must not break the college or the department's rules for the use of computers (these can be found on the college website).
- You must not break any copyright laws by using third party code or content without consent.

If this is your first time building a web or mobile application you may wish to treat the following suggestions as additional requirements:

- It is suggested that you use a **DoC CloudStack virtual machine** provided by CSG to deploy your digital touchpoint. You are free to use your own public machine, or external servers, but CSG will not be able to provide support for these.
- It is suggested that you use a **Postgresql database** that can be provided to you by CSG. You are free to use your own database, but CSG will not be able to support this.

Timetable and Assessment

The timetable for the DRP project, and the weighting of each Task, are given below:

Date	Task	Mark
19th March	Organise your Group	-
22nd May	Milestone Assessment 1	5%
29th May	Milestone Assessment 2	5%
2nd June	Law Case Study TRA	10%
5th June	Milestone Assessment 3	5%
12th June	Milestone Assessment 4	5%
16th & 17th June	Final Demonstration and Presentation	50%
19th June	Project Documentation	20%

The full exercise schedule for the Summer Term can be [found on Scientia](#).

Milestone Assessments

Following agile methods, this project will be broken up into four separate iterations. The first iteration will be assessed by a strictly timed 3-minute elevator-pitch micro-presentation. Each of the following iterations will be assessed by a 15-20 minute project progress meeting with the DoC and RCA module tutors. These milestones exist to allow you to practise true agile development processes, but also to offer you some guidance on the direction of your project.

Each week's Milestone Overview lecture will offer additional guidance on how to apply Human Centred Design techniques to your project and how industrial teams work effectively in practice.

The First Iteration

The first project iteration is intended as an idea generation phase. During this iteration you should settle on your project theme (the real-world problem to solve), its motivating evidence, your target audience (who are you designing for) and your initial insights into the problem.

Your **3-minute elevator pitch** should outline your chosen project theme and focus on:

- The **problem** your project aims to solve.
- The specific **target audience** for your project.
- The **evidence** that backs up the challenge and potential of the project.
- Your **observations and insights** into the problem area and potential solutions.
- A clear **opportunity statement** (how might we?) for your project.

Be aware that it is the content of the micro-presentation that will be assessed, not the quality of the video or support material. As such, you should not spend too long working on such material, but rather focus your work on clearly defining your project's context, scope, target audience and opportunity statement.

The Following Iterations

For the remaining project iterations you will be expected to revisit the current scenario of your chosen project to further clarify the challenges for the people involved, to better understand the impact on them and to identify the point you got to with the previous iteration.

You should then highlight how you intend to develop your digital touchpoint to seamlessly integrate into this experience, what you've learned from your users and how this feedback has manifested in the development of your digital touchpoint during this iteration.

You may want to create some notes or one or two slides to help you explain what you chose to do that week, how you did it and how you verified its quality. As before, be aware that it is the content of the discussions during the project progress meetings that will be assessed, not the quality of the support material. As such, you should not spend too long working on such material, but rather focus your work on designing your problem solution and the supporting digital touchpoint.

Final Demonstration and Presentation

The DRP project will culminate in a 20-minute integrated demonstration and presentation of your design proposition where you will: set the context of your project, highlight the challenges and opportunities of the problem, tell us who's involved and show us how someone would now interact with your new digital touchpoint within the context of the problem.

This will be followed by 5 minutes of feedback from a panel of DoC and RCA tutors.

The presentation should include:

- **An Introduction to your Project:**
Succinctly set the scene/context of your motivating problem and highlight the challenges and opportunities faced by those involved.
- **A Discussion of How your Digital Touchpoint Addresses the Problem:**
Explain how users would interact with the digital touchpoint you have designed for your chosen scenario, and in so doing, demonstrate its technical workings.
- **A Discussion of your Language/Framework Choices:**
Explain the programming languages and frameworks that you used to create your digital touchpoint and justify these choices or make comparisons with alternatives.
- **A System Architecture Overview:**
Discuss how your digital touchpoint has been built and how its components interact, giving an overview of their implementation.
- **A Conclusion/Evaluation:**
Reflect on the outcome of your project and identify possibilities for future work on it. Summarise what you have done, what you have not done, what you have learned from the project and what you would do differently in the future.

We expect all members of your group to be present and each person should speak for an equal amount of time during the presentation.

Project Documentation

Rather than writing a full project report for this module, you will instead be asked to prepare a small portfolio of documents that detail certain specific aspects of your DRP project.

We expect that the bulk of the content will have been developed during the project itself and that your documentation submission simply provides some narrative for this work.

You will need to provide the following documentation:

1. **Project Pitch Leaflet**

In one or two short paragraphs you should sum up the purpose of your digital touchpoint and its use. This discussion should be backed up by a well-chosen screen-shot or mock-up of your digital touchpoint in action.

This document should be suitable to generate interest in your digital touchpoint if handed out at a project fair or publicity event.

2. **Copyright/Legal Issues Report**

In a list or table you should acknowledge any libraries, code or pictures that are used in your final digital touchpoint and have not been written or created by your group.

In a short paragraph you should also briefly discuss any legal issues that you would have to consider if you were to officially release your digital touchpoint.

This document should be suitable for a future development team to understand the legal constraints placed upon them within the scope of continuing work on this project.

3. **Human Centred Design Techniques Portfolio**

The DRP project is a vehicle for students to explore design methods and tools in order to inspire new thinking and develop digital innovation, always with the aim of creating new and improved experiences for people, whatever the context.

This portfolio should be an engaging and visual representation of your approach, illustrating your team's use of Human Centred Design techniques at each stage of your project, and your reflections on what you learned and how this contributed to the ongoing development of your digital touchpoint. A suggested approach would be to include the design methods and approaches you've used throughout the project, and reflections on how these helped guide you in the development of your propositions.

These materials can be created in any way that you wish, but should visualise the methods that you have used throughout your project. You are encouraged to use diagrams to convey information where possible, but these should also be backed up with a few lines of text to explain your approach and what you have learned.

Module Staff

RCA Module Leads:

Carolyn Runcie, Tutor, Service Design – Royal College of Art

Nick de Leon, Service Design - Royal College of Art

Imperial Module Leads:

Mark Wheelhouse, Principal Teaching Fellow - Imperial College London DoC

Jamie Willis, Teaching Fellow - Imperial College London DoC

Ivan Procaccini, Senior Learning Technologist - Imperial College London DoC

RCA Tutor Team:



**Andrea Edmunds, Visiting Tutor,
Service Design - Royal College of Art**

Andrea is a service designer at Nationwide Building Society where she uses design research to improve the customer experience. Her extensive service design background drives her holistic approach to understanding and improving end to end customer journeys. Formerly Head of insights at the Future Cities Catapult and Head of IDEO's

London Service Design practice, she draws on extensive experience across a wide variety of sectors, including technology, sustainability, healthcare and financial services.

Andrea opened her own consultancy in 2017, focusing on digital and cultural transformation of organisations and services including EY, HSBC and Digital Built Britain. Formerly Head of Insight at the Future Cities Catapult, an organisation championing urban services and smart cities, Andrea led the design of the Urban Innovation Centre and established a process and research design team to ensure that people are not forgotten in the rush to embrace technology and big data. Her work covered sustainable mobility, air pollution, urban planning, SMEs and citizen engagement for the likes of TfL and cities around the world.

Prior to FCC, Andrea spent 12 years at the world-renowned design and innovation agency IDEO. Building on her prior experience in mechanical engineering manufacturing in Silicon Valley, she focussed on product design before moving to London where she headed up IDEO's Service Design practice. Her work across a huge variety of clients and industries include the public and third sectors (Oxfam) as well as financial services (UBS, Barclays), healthcare (Novartis, Pfizer, the NHS) and products (Hoover, Steelcase, IKEA, Nestlé).

Andrea has taught design process at her alma mater, Stanford University (BS Mechanical Engineering/Product Design) and at the Academy of Art University in California. She has lectured at numerous institutions including Cambridge's Judge School of Business, the Design Council, and at conferences across the USA and Europe. Andrea has served on several advisory boards including Oxfam, Ravensbourne School of Design, BSI and Milton Keynes 2050.

**Carolyn Runcie, Tutor, Service Design - Royal College of Art**

Carolyn is a design educator with 17 years of experience in delivering progressive design programmes in two world class Higher Education Institutions - the Royal College of Art and Imperial College London. She has led pioneering work that has transformed approaches in teaching and learning within diverse academic settings, helping to produce future leaders with the design skills, capabilities and confidence to address the seismic challenges faced in business, technology and the creative industries.

Carolyn played a key role in setting up the Masters in Service Design programme at the Royal College of Art in 2012 and develops the formal taught elements of the course. She has developed the overall structure, narrative and specification of content and manages partnerships with relevant RCA and external contributors.

Carolyn has contributed to a range of projects and research papers on the value of design in the UK and overseas. These include a paper, [‘Design-led Innovation.’](#) for the International Conference on Engineering and Product Design Education based on a successful new design course in the Faculty of Engineering at Imperial College (2008-2018); a research project, [SusLabNWE](#), at the RCA that explored people’s perceptions and ideas about domestic energy consumption; an academic paper, [‘Is Service Design in Demand?’](#) investigating the professional roles of graduates from the Masters in Service Design programme at the RCA, and exploring the nature and demand for service design in the private, public and 3rd sectors; an academic paper written by the RCA-Imperial DRP team, [‘Designing for Real People: Teaching Agility through User-Centric Service Design’](#) that shares approaches in education on teaching agile software development through an unwavering focus on the user.

Prior to joining the Higher Education sector, Carolyn worked in the Global Banking Healthcare Group at Deutsche Bank AG, designed language courses in Italy and taught in Primary Education in London.

**Cecilia Santucho**

Cecilia is a [Policy and Social- driven Innovation Strategist](#) with 15+ years of experience applying systemic approaches and mixed methods to drive positive change. She has worked across public, private, and non-profit sectors in Argentina and the EMEA region, developing strategic *Cases for Change*, informing executive-level decision-making, and leading transformation processes that have resulted in new regulations, policies, public services, and business initiatives

across sectors such as healthcare, education, creative industries, social innovation, tourism, and consumer goods. Thanks to her diverse academic background spanning Political Science, Management Science, and a MA in Service Design from the RCA, Cecilia brings methodological integration and multidisciplinary fluency to tackle complex challenges and support collaborative problem-solving. She currently serves as a Tutor in Innovation Design at UCL, has delivered lectures on systemic thinking and participatory design, and has mentored professionals, equipping them with the mindsets and tools needed to embed HCD approaches into their practice



Clare Brass is a designer with extensive experience in creating and teaching sustainable/circular systems design. Her work explores ways of using design to create positive social/environmental business. She has worked at various prestigious institutions including the Royal College of Art, Imperial College London, Cambridge University and Berkeley.

Clare was formerly leader of sustainability and entrepreneurship in IDE. She also set up and ran SustainRCA, a cross-disciplinary unit to inspire, encourage and support students across the college to address global social / environmental challenges in their work.

She set up Department 22 in 2016 with two RCA graduates to explore sustainable/circular food systems, later co-founding Moree, where she is Chief Product Officer.



David Eveleigh-Evans, Creative Director; Tutor RCA; Founder, Managing Director

David is a recognised design leader and award winning designer, with over 20+ years of experience across brands, products and services. He has led some of the world's best design studios, including Method Inc, leading design across London, New York and San Francisco with clients such as Google, Nike, Sonos, Microsoft, McDonalds, Skype, Samsung, Sky and AT&T (to name a few).

He has collaborated with many global brands, startups and led moonshot innovation to drive change and social impact through design. Along the way he has won D&AD, Art Directors Club, AIGA, Red Dot, Cannes Lions, CR and European Design awards.

Applying his creative energy, David has founded several creative businesses including a design studio, furniture and children's wear label. Most recently DORK a creative disruptor looking at remaking the future in responsible, ethical ways that are good for people and the planet.

David graduated from the RCA in 1998 from the pioneering CRD course run by Gillian Crampton Smith and is delighted to be back as a tutor.



Jane Prithcard, Tutor, Service Design - Royal College of Art

As a design thinking and innovation professional, Jane has over twenty years of experience leading clients through a wide spectrum of creative challenges. She's helped client teams transform their brands, products and services as well as support them to embed design thinking tools within the context of their own organisations. With a background in design strategy, she is passionate about using human centred design methods to tackle a broad set of challenges across multiple industries.

She specialises in user/consumer/audience research, design thinking (methods, process, mindsets), design strategy (identification of opportunities for new service & product propositions), human-centred innovation, executive level workshop planning & facilitation, and managing design within large organisations.



Dr Nick de Leon

Nick received his PhD from Imperial College Business School, where his research addressed the impact of information and communication technologies on the social and economic vitality of cities. He has an engineering degree from Imperial College and a Master's degree in Industrial Design from the Royal College of Art.

Dr Leon began his career as an industrial designer at IBM, moving from designing products then services, through to developing entire new businesses in his role as Business Development Director for IBM's Global Services division in Europe. He led the NESTA-funded joint venture between the RCA and Imperial College London, Design London, as director from 2007 to 2011, before founding the Service Design MA programme at the Royal College of Art. He is now Executive Education and Knowledge Exchange Lead at the RCA.



Sooyoung Oh is a Service Designer and UX Researcher who specialises in uncovering hidden user needs through primary research and driving cross-functional collaboration to create seamless, human-centred solutions.

Her expertise lies in conducting in-depth user research, ensuring every design decision is data-driven and user-informed. Having worked across customer service, marketing, and operations, she brings first-hand experience of business functions and a strong understanding of business strategy. This allows her to effectively communicate with stakeholders, streamline workflows, and design solutions that are both user-centric and operationally feasible.



Tom Stables is a Multidisciplinary Designer and Researcher specialising in healthcare and usability. In addition to his own design practice, he is currently based at the Helen Hamlyn Centre for Design at the Royal College of Art.

Trisha Fernandes



Trisha is a Service Designer and HFI Certified Usability Analyst (CUA) with a Master's in Service Design from the Royal College of Art, London. Her background includes experience as a Lead Experience Designer at Infosys - Wongdoody, where she collaborated with global clients, as well as roles at Deloitte and Philips, through which she gained exposure to a variety of domains. Her recent involvement included organising the SDN Next Gen Conference, centered on 'Dare to Impact'. Her strengths include user research,

critical analysis, systems and strategic thinking, service blueprints, ideation and prototyping. Trisha's collaborative nature and passion for impactful design make her journey dynamic and exciting.

RCA Masters in Service Design student team

[Altamash Kadri](#)

[Afreen Iqbal](#)

[Alexandra Bassil](#)

[Pooja Narendra Rumale](#)

[Rodrigo Nunes](#)

[Zainab Goriawala](#)

[Zioedy Wong](#)

Human Centred Design References

Human Centred Design Textbooks / Source Materials:

There is no single textbook that covers the module. A list of readings relating to the lectures and cases will be provided from the following selection of books, papers

Introduction:

- When Innovation meets institutions: Edison and the Design of the Electric Light, A Hargadon and Y Douglas, Administrative Science Quarterly 46, 2001, p 476 - 501
- Design Thinking, Tim Brown, Harvard Business Review, June 2008, p 84 – 92

Discover and Define:

- IDEO (user-centred design and design thinking) www.designkit.org/methods
Design Methods for Developing Services, Design Council and Technology Strategy Board (part of module documentation)
- Empathetic Engineer - <https://www.empatheticengineer.org/tools>
- Universal Methods of Design, B. Martin & B. Hanington, Rockport (2012)

Design and Develop:

- Designing the User Interface by B. Shneiderman, Addison Wesley Press, 2004.
- <http://www.nesta.org.uk/publications/prototyping-framework>
- <https://www.thisisservicedesigndoing.com/methods/rehearsing-digital-services>
- <https://www.thisisservicedesigndoing.com/methods/interactive-click-modeling>
- Interaction Design by H. Sharp, Y. Rogers & J. Preece, John Wiley Press, 2006
- Designing Interactions by W. Moggridge, MIT Press, 2006
- Hertzian Tales: Electronic Products, Aesthetic Experience, and Critical Design, Anthony Dunne, MIT Press, 2008

Appendix A: Database Beginners Guide

As mentioned in the requirements, you will need to track the state of your supporting digital touchpoint in a database.

You may request the creation of a database in your project area that you could modify to include all of the tables needed to support your project's digital touchpoint. If you do not consider yourself experienced with database design/use, then we recommend that you stick to using such a provided database. To access the provided database you will need to follow the instructions sent to by CSG after requesting a database be set-up for your group. This will include the database password allocated by CSG for your group.

Alternatively, you could choose to create your own database either locally or externally. Note that we **do** expect you to actually maintain your own database, rather than utilising a third-party database as a service.

An example database structure can be provided on request in the file `trader.sql`. This file contains definitions of the tables to create in the database and the commands to load data into these tables. You may find it helpful to read and edit this file to suit your own purposes. To load the table definitions and initial data specified by the `.sql` file start `psql`, specifying your database name, and from the `psql` prompt type `\i trader.sql`.

The department's database server is regularly backed up. However, if you are using your own database server, or if you want to save the database before making a major change, then you can use the command `pg_dump` to create an `.sql` file that can be used to restore the database later. The command,

```
pg_dump --host=db --inserts MyDatabase --file saved.sql
```

writes the commands and data that will recreate 'MyDatabase' to the file 'saved.sql'. This can then be read back into a fresh database using the commands as described for `trader.sql` above.

Note: The SQL standard does not include any commands to change the definition of an existing table in a database. However, Postgresql has an extra command `ALTER TABLE` that allows you to add or remove a column in a table or to change names and types in a table. More information about Postgresql can be found in the [online Postgresql documentation](#).

If you choose to use a database other than a Postgresql one provided by CSG (such as MySQL) we recommend that you avoid using non-standard SQL. This will ensure that your digital touchpoint could be easily converted to using Postgresql if you decide to migrate back to a provided database later in the project.

Appendix B: An Example App

We provide an example mobile application description and some basic user interactions for an exam invigilator communication system. This example should be treated as a suggestion only and you are encouraged to come up with your own ideas.

Purpose: During the main summer exam season, due to extra time candidates and the popularity of certain modules, it is common for candidates of an exam to be split over multiple rooms. It is important that the invigilators in these rooms be able to communicate with one another in order to synchronise start/finish times, announce clarifications/corrections and enable examiners to answer queries from candidates. This can be particularly troublesome in rooms with just a single invigilator. Mobile phones can sometimes be useful, but not everyone has their phone on them, not everyone knows one-another's numbers and people's phones will necessarily be on silent, so messages can easily be missed. We suggest an app that allows for a phone or tablet in each room to be connected to a central communication server that relays messages and status information silently between the rooms.

Requirements: Here is a partial list of requirements that such a system would need to fulfil:

- The system must operate silently. Candidates must not be disturbed during their exams.
- The system should broadcast continuous updates so that messages are not 'missed'.
- Messages should be receipt confirmed so that the sender knows that their message has been received.
- Each room should have a status (e.g. stopped, under-way, assistance) displayed at all times during the exam. These status's need to update in real-time across the system.
- The system should display a log of status changes and messages.
- The system should be able to handle examiners moving between rooms during an exam.

User Interactions: Here is a partial list of user interactions that would need to be supported:

- Examiners/invigilators should be able to easily see which room(s) need assistance.
- An invigilator needs to be able to notify the system when the exam in their room starts/stops. The room's status should be appropriately updated.
- An invigilator needs to be able to ask for an examiner to come to their room to answer a question. Note that there may be multiple examiners for a single exam, and that multiple exams may be running in a single room.
- An invigilator needs to be able to ask for an invigilator to assist them in their room (e.g. a candidate may need to be escorted to the bathroom).
- An examiner/invigilator needs to be able to acknowledge that they have received a request to come to a particular room. Additionally this receipt should be broadcast so that requests are not over-served.
- An examiner needs to be able to ask for an announcement to be read out in all rooms that contain a certain exam. Each room must acknowledge when the announcement has been made.

Screen Shot Mock-up:

